

The Backlog System — Cheat Sheet

Day-to-day use. You add ideas; Claude Code does the rest. You never open the spreadsheet.

Add an idea (anytime, from anywhere)

- **From your phone:** Files app → iCloud Drive → backlog-inbox.txt → type one idea per line.
- **Want to think it through first?** Brainstorm in the Claude Project — it hands you the exact line to jot in the inbox.
- **At your Mac, on the spot:** just tell Claude Code “add to the backlog: ...”

Process the backlog (end of a work session)

- **First, close BACKLOG.xlsx in Excel** if it's open — Claude Code can't write to a locked file.
- Then say the phrase below to Claude Code.

The one phrase to remember

We just finished a sprint — run the end-of-sprint backlog check.

Claude Code then, in order:

- Reads the inbox and turns each idea into a full backlog row, then clears the inbox.
- Lists the new (and any pending) items and asks you: do it now, or schedule for later?
- Does the “now” items in priority order, marks them Done, writes notes, and refreshes the dashboard.

See the backlog

- Open (and keep open) BACKLOG/dashboard.html. It refreshes itself every 45 seconds, or click “Refresh now.”
- **Sort by date** (Newest first surfaces your latest additions), or **filter by source** — yours vs. Claude's — using the controls at the top. The count cards show how many open items are yours vs. Claude's.

Good to know

- **Never open the spreadsheet to edit it** — Claude Code owns it. You only use the inbox (to add) and the dashboard (to view).
- **Empty inbox = you're caught up.** Everything you jotted is in the backlog.
- **Vague lines stay put.** If an idea is too thin to build, Claude Code leaves it in the inbox and asks you to clarify — nothing is lost.

If the inbox seems ignored

If Claude Code says the inbox is empty when it isn't, the terminal app running Claude Code needs Full Disk Access (the inbox lives in iCloud, which macOS protects). Turn it on in System Settings > Privacy & Security > Full Disk Access, then quit and reopen that app.